Records Retention Policy

Policy owner	Head of Information Governance
Approved by	Audit and Risk Committee
Applies to	All staff, board members, contractors and volunteers
Next review	May 2027

1 Purpose

1.1 This policy sets out how long Fenmore Housing Association keeps its records and how records are disposed of when their retention period ends.

1.2 Keeping records for the right length of time helps us meet our legal duties, answer questions from tenants and regulators, and avoid keeping personal data for longer than we need it.

2 Scope

2.1 This policy applies to records in every format, including paper files, email, case management systems, shared drives, voice recordings and CCTV footage.

2.2 It does not apply to historical material transferred to the county archive, which is governed by the deposit agreement with the archive service.

3 Roles and responsibilities

3.1 The Head of Information Governance owns this policy, maintains the retention schedule in Appendix A and reports on compliance to the Audit and Risk Committee once a year.

3.2 Each Information Asset Owner makes sure that the records in their area are listed in the retention schedule, that the retention periods are applied and that disposal is recorded.

3.3 All staff must file records in the agreed systems, must not keep personal copies of records and must ask the Information Governance team when they are unsure how long to keep something.

3.4 Contractors who hold records on our behalf must follow this policy or an equivalent policy agreed in their contract.

4 Retention principles

4.1 Records are kept for the period shown in the retention schedule. The period starts from the trigger event stated in the schedule, such as the end of a tenancy or the date a case was closed.

4.2 Where a record is subject to a legal hold, a complaint or an open request from a regulator, it must not be destroyed until the Information Governance team confirms that the hold has been lifted.

4.3 Paper records may be scanned and the paper copy destroyed after a quality check of a sample of the scanned batch.

4.4 Duplicate and working copies are kept only for as long as they are needed for day-to-day work and never for longer than the master record.

5 Disposal

5.1 Paper records that contain personal data are shredded on site or collected in locked bins by an approved contractor, who provides a certificate of destruction for each collection.

5.2 Electronic records are deleted from live systems at the end of the retention period and are removed from backups within 90 days by the normal backup rotation.

5.3 Each disposal is recorded in the disposal log with the record class, the date range, the method used and the name of the person who approved it.

6 Monitoring and review

6.1 The Information Governance team checks a sample of disposal logs each quarter and reports exceptions to the Information Asset Owners concerned.

6.2 This policy is reviewed every two years, or earlier if the law or our systems change.

Appendix A — Retention schedule

Periods run from the trigger event. Where two periods apply, the longer one is used. Disposal methods are described in section 5.

Ref	Record class	Examples	Owner	Retention	Trigger	Disposal
R01	Tenancy files	Tenancy agreement, sign-up documents, correspondence	Lettings Team	6 years	End of tenancy	Confidential shredding
R02	Rent accounts	Rent statements, arrears letters, payment plans	Income Team	6 years	End of financial year	Delete from system
R03	Housing applications, unsuccessful	Application form, evidence, decision letter	Lettings Team	2 years	Date of decision	Delete from system
R04	Repairs records	Job tickets, inspection photos, completion notes	Property Services	6 years	Job completion	Delete from system
R05	Gas safety certificates	Landlord gas safety records	Compliance Team	3 years	Date of check	Delete from system
R06	Asbestos surveys	Survey reports, register entries, removal records	Compliance Team	40 years	Date of survey	Review, then archive
R07	Anti-social behaviour cases	Case notes, witness statements, legal action	Tenancy Enforcement	6 years	Case closed	Confidential shredding
R08	Complaints	Complaint, investigation notes, response letters	Customer Experience	3 years	Complaint closed	Delete from system
R09	CCTV footage	Recordings from estate cameras	Neighbourhood Team	31 days	Date of recording	Automatic overwrite
R10	Staff personnel files	Contract, appraisals, training records	People Team	6 years	End of employment	Confidential shredding
R11	Recruitment, unsuccessful candidates	Applications, interview notes	People Team	6 months	Date of decision	Delete from system
R12	Payroll records	Payslips, tax forms, pension contributions	Finance Team	6 years	End of tax year	Delete from system
R13	Board papers and minutes	Agendas, papers, signed minutes	Governance Officer	Permanent	Date of meeting	Transfer to archive
R14	Contracts with suppliers	Signed contracts, variations, tender documents	Procurement Team	12 years	Contract end	Review, then delete
R15	Accident and incident reports	Report forms, investigation notes	Health and Safety Lead	10 years	Date of incident	Review, then delete
R16	Call recordings	Customer service call recordings	Customer Experience	90 days	Date of call	Automatic deletion

Appendix B — Document control

Version	Date	Summary of changes
2.0	9 March 2021	Full rewrite after the systems migration
3.0	2 June 2023	Retention schedule moved to Appendix A; CCTV and call recordings added
3.1	14 May 2025	Review dates updated; asbestos period corrected

Questions about this policy go to the Information Governance team, extension 4410.